



WA Counter-Strike — PUG Rulebook

Effective date: 22 June 2026

This rulebook governs participation in WA Counter-Strike ("WACS") **pick-up games ("PUGs")** for Counter-Strike 2 ("CS2"). PUGs are organised through the WACS Discord and played on WACS servers. By joining a PUG lobby or playing in a PUG, all players agree to comply with these rules.

PUGs are separate from the WA League and One Day Cups, which are governed by the main WACS Competition Rulebook.

Where a rule asks you to contact WACS, do so by **DMing a staff member on Discord** or **opening a ticket at wa-cs.com/support**.

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1. General Overview

1.1 Purpose

This rulebook exists to keep PUGs fair, balanced, and enjoyable. It defines how PUGs are formed and played, what conduct is expected, and how players are penalised for disrupting games.

1.2 Scope & Application

This rulebook covers WACS PUGs only. The WA League and One Day Cups are governed by the main WACS Competition Rulebook.

PUGs run on a rolling basis through the WACS Discord, with results feeding a per-season standings leaderboard.

1.3 Administration

The Tournament Organizer reserves the right to:

- Modify these rules at any time
- Interpret these rules where they are unclear
- Issue rulings in circumstances not covered by this book

- Penalize players for behaviour detrimental to PUGs

Staff rulings are final, subject only to the appeals process in Section 12.3.

1.4 Definitions

- **TO / Tournament Organizer** — WA Counter-Strike (WACS), the operator of the competition.
- **Staff** — WACS administrators and officials authorised to run PUGs and issue rulings.
- **PUG** — a pick-up game: a one-off match formed from individual sign-ups rather than fixed teams.
- **Lobby** — the Discord queue players join to be placed into a PUG.
- **Captain** — a player chosen to draft and lead one side in a PUG.
- **Draft** — the process by which captains pick their teams from the lobby.
- **ELO** — a player's skill rating, which rises and falls with PUG results.
- **Abandon** — leaving a PUG before it finishes without permission or a valid reason.
- **Substitute (sub)** — a player pulled from the queue to replace someone who leaves.
- **Veto** — the process of banning maps down to the one that will be played.
- **Knife round** — a round played with knives only to decide starting sides.
- **MR12** — "Maximum Rounds 12"; each half is 12 rounds, and the first team to 13 rounds wins.
- **Active Duty pool** — the current competitive map pool used in official Valve and tier-one events.

2. Eligibility

All players must:

- Own a valid Steam account and use that registered account when playing
- Not be banned by Valve Anti-Cheat (VAC) or by the platforms WACS uses
- Be residents of Western Australia
- Be 16 years of age or older (players under 16 may play only with verifiable parental or guardian consent provided to staff on request)

There is no skill or rank requirement to play PUGs. Players may not share accounts, smurf, or use alternate accounts.

3. Player Conduct

3.1 Sportsmanship

All players must behave respectfully toward each other, toward staff, and toward the wider community. Competitive trash talk is acceptable. Harassment, abuse, and threats are not.

3.2 Prohibited Conduct

The following are strictly prohibited:

- Harassment
- Racism, sexism, homophobia, or any other hate speech
- Threats or intimidation
- Excessive toxicity
- Match fixing
- Stream sniping
- Impersonation
- Intentionally throwing or griefing a game

3.3 Cheating

Cheating in any form is forbidden, including:

- Aimbots
- Wallhacks
- Radar hacks
- Trigger bots
- Scripting and macros — this includes snap-tap / SOCD-style movement features (rapid trigger is acceptable)
- Exploiting unintended game bugs
- Unauthorised third-party software

Any player found cheating may face immediate removal and a permanent ban from WACS.

3.4 Anti-Cheat & Prior Bans

WACS relies on **VAC** and **post-match demo review** for cheat detection.

WACS also recognises cheating bans issued elsewhere. A player who is currently banned for cheating by Valve (VAC), a recognised anti-cheat provider, or another reputable platform or tournament organiser may be refused entry to, or removed from, WACS PUGs — whether or not the conduct occurred at a WACS event. Players must disclose any such ban on request. Whether a given ban applies is determined at staff discretion.

4. Joining a PUG

4.1 Lobby & Queue

Players join a PUG by entering the lobby in the WACS Discord. A PUG forms once **ten (10) players** are in the lobby. Additional players remain in the queue and may be drawn in as substitutes (see Section 8).

4.2 Captains

When the lobby fills, the **two highest-ELO players** are made captains, one for each side.

4.3 Draft

The captains draft the remaining eight players into their teams:

- Captains pick in **straight alternating turns**.
- The captain who does not take the first pick takes the final pick, so each captain ends with **four** drafted players (five including themselves).

Once both teams are set, the captains move to the veto.

5. Match Format & Veto

Every PUG is a **single map (Best of One)**.

The veto is handled on the WACS website at wa-cs.com. The two captains check in, then ban maps in **straight alternating turns** from the Active Duty pool (see Section 6.4) until **one map remains**, which is played. Each captain has **1 minute per ban** by default. Staff may run the veto manually if needed.

Starting sides on the chosen map are decided by a **knife round**.

6. Game Settings

6.1 Game Version

All PUGs are played on the latest live version of Counter-Strike 2 unless staff state otherwise.

6.2 Match Settings

Standard competitive settings apply:

- MR12 format (first to 13 rounds)
- Overtime enabled (see Section 6.3)
- Competitive damage settings

- Friendly fire enabled
- Team collision enabled

6.3 Overtime

If the map is tied 12–12, it is decided in overtime:

- Overtime is played **MR3** (first to 4 rounds wins the overtime).
- Each team starts overtime with **\$10,000**.
- Teams switch sides after every three rounds.
- If an overtime ends tied, a further overtime is played under the same rules until a winner is decided.

6.4 Map Pool

PUGs use the **current CS2 Active Duty map pool** as set by Valve, so that play matches tier-one tournaments. At the time of writing, that pool is:

- Ancient
- Anubis
- Dust II
- Inferno
- Mirage
- Nuke
- Overpass

When Valve updates the Active Duty pool, WACS follows suit.

7. Ready-Up & Punctuality

Once teams and the map are set, all players must join the server and ready up.

- Players have **5 minutes** to join and ready up after the server is created.
- A player who fails to ready up in time is treated as a no-show and may be replaced by a substitute (see Section 8).
- The match goes live once all ten players are ready.

8. Abandons, No-Shows & Substitutes

8.1 Substitutes

If a player leaves or fails to ready up, staff or the system may pull a **substitute** from the queue so the PUG can continue. A PUG should be completed with a substitute wherever possible rather than cancelled.

8.2 No-Shows

A player who is drafted but does not join and ready up within the time allowed (Section 7) is a **no-show**. A no-show is replaced by a substitute and receives a penalty under Section 8.4.

8.3 Abandons

Leaving a live PUG before it finishes — without staff permission or a genuine reason — is an **abandon**. Going AFK for an extended period or deliberately throwing a game is treated as an abandon at staff discretion.

An abandon is recorded as a **loss with the full ELO penalty** for that player, and the game continues with a substitute.

8.4 Penalties for Abandoning & No-Shows

The following queue bans apply, escalating by how many offences a player has in a rolling **30-day** period:

- **1st offence** — 24-hour queue ban
- **2nd offence** — 3-day queue ban
- **3rd offence** — 7-day queue ban
- **4th or more** — staff review, up to an indefinite queue ban

Staff may waive or reduce a penalty where a player left for a genuine emergency, and may increase it for repeated or deliberate disruption.

9. Pauses & Disconnects

9.1 Tactical Pauses

Each team may take tactical pauses according to the match settings — by default, **three (3) pauses of 30 seconds** each.

9.2 Technical Pauses

Technical pauses are allowed for genuine technical problems, such as server issues, hardware failure, internet instability, and game crashes. Staff may request proof. Where a technical issue cannot be resolved in reasonable time, staff decide how the game proceeds.

9.3 Disconnects

If a player disconnects, the game continues unless a valid pause is called. A reasonable amount of time may be granted to reconnect. If delays become excessive, staff may direct play to continue, or pull in a substitute.

10. ELO & Standings

Every player carries an **ELO** rating that rises when they win and falls when they lose. PUG results feed a **per-season standings leaderboard**.

- Abandoning or no-showing counts as a **loss** for ELO purposes (Section 8).
- Substitutes who complete a game receive the result like any other player.
- Staff may correct ratings or standings affected by a technical fault, a remade game, or a confirmed rule breach.

11. Technical Issues

Players are responsible for a stable internet connection, functional peripherals, an updated game client, and proper account access. Where there is a server problem, staff may restart the game, restore rounds where possible, remake the game, or move servers.

12. Protests, Appeals & Disputes

12.1 Filing a Protest

A protest must:

- Be raised promptly, ideally during or immediately after the game
- Include evidence (for example, screenshots, demos, or clips)
- Be submitted respectfully
- Be lodged by **DMing a staff member on Discord** or **opening a ticket at wa-cs.com/support**

12.2 Staff Decisions

Staff rulings are final, subject only to the appeals process below.

12.3 Appeals

A ruling may be appealed:

- Lodge the appeal via wa-cs.com/support within 72 hours of the ruling.
- The appeal must include **new evidence** not already considered in the original ruling.
- A senior staff member **not involved in the original decision** will review the appeal.
- The outcome of the appeal is final.

13. Penalties

13.1 Types of Penalties

Penalties may include:

- Warnings
- Queue bans
- ELO or standings adjustments
- Removal from a game
- Suspensions
- Permanent bans

13.2 Escalation

Repeated or severe violations may result in increased penalties. Staff decide the appropriate penalty for each situation.

14. Media & Content Rights

By participating, players grant the TO permission to broadcast PUGs, use player names, record gameplay, and publish highlights and promotional content.

15. Rule Changes

The Tournament Organizer reserves the right to update this rulebook, resolve situations it does not cover, and act to preserve fair and balanced PUGs. Major changes will be communicated where possible.

16. Final Agreement

Playing in a WACS PUG constitutes full acceptance of:

- This rulebook
- Staff decisions
- Platform rules
- Applicable game publisher policies

Failure to comply may result in queue bans or removal from WACS PUGs.